Pus is a thick protein rich fluid called as liquor puris. It consists of dead white blood cells and infected agents. It is a natural product formed during immunological reactions against infecting agents. It might be yellow or green or brown in colour and with foul odour. Appearance of pus at the site of surgery indicates an infection.

10.2.1. Bacterial Infections

Bacterial infections include any type of illness caused by bacteria. Based on the structure and shape,there are three major groups of bacteria namely, Bacillus (cylindrical forms), Coccus (spherical forms) and Spiral. Humans and animals have abundant normal flora (microbes) that usually do not produce disease under normal healthy condition. These bacteria are referred to as good bacteria or healthy bacteria or normal flora. Harmful bacteria that cause bacterial infections and disease are called pathogenic bacteria. Bacterial diseases occur when pathogenic bacteria enter into the body and begin to reproduce and to grow in tissues that are normally sterile. Harmful bacteria may also emit toxins that can damage the body.

Name of Disease	Pathogen	Mode of transmission	Incubation Period	Symptoms	Therapy
Pulmonary Tuberculosis	*Mycobacterium tuberculosis*	Airborne and Droplet infection	2-10 weeks	Coughing; chest pain and bloody sputum	Streptomycin, para-amino salicylic acid, rifampicin
Diphtheria	*Corynebacterium diphtheriae*	Airborne and Droplet infection	2-6 days	Inflammation of mucosa of nasal chamber, throat etc. respiratory tract blocked	Diphtheria antitoxins, Penicillin, Erythromycin
Cholera	*Vibrio cholerae*	Direct and oral with contaminated food and water	6 hours to 2 – 3 days	Acute diarrhoea and dehydration	Oral rehydration therapy and tetracycline
Leprosy	*Mycobacterium leprae*	Slowest, infectious and contagious	2-5 years	Skin hypopigmentation, nodulated skin, deformity of fingers and toes.	Dapsone, rifampicin, Clofazimine

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